La Necar Logistics LLC

# Supporting Regulation During Car Rides

Practical, care-centered strategies for supporting adults with intellectual and developmental disabilities during transport, so every journey feels confident and manageable.



## La Necar Logistics

*Care Comes First in Accessible Transport*

# Introduction

## Transportation Is More Than a Ride; It Is an Experience

Transportation is more than arrival. For the adults you support, a car ride can involve real sensory challenges, communication barriers, anxiety, and moments of dysregulation that are difficult to anticipate, and even harder to manage on the move.

Whether you're a family carer who has been navigating this for years, or a support worker looking for better strategies, this guide was built for you. It draws on the experience of the La Necar team: specialists in accessible transport for people with intellectual and developmental disabilities, to give you a clear, practical framework you can use straight away.



# How to use this guide

## Getting the most from this resource

This guide follows the arc of a real journey — preparation, the ride itself, and how to respond if things become difficult. Each section is short and action-focused. You don't need to read it end to end; go straight to the part that's most relevant to where you're at right now.

**Section 1: Before you go**
Setting the person up for a calm, predictable journey before you leave

**Section 2: During the ride**
Keeping the person regulated and supported while you're moving

**Section 3: If things escalate**
The 3-S Rule — a calm, step-by-step response to moments of distress

This guide is most useful when you can refer back to it before or after a challenging journey.

# Before You Go: Setting Everyone Up for Success

Many behaviours during car rides are a form of communication. An adult who is uncomfortable, anxious, or overwhelmed may not always be able to express how they feel in the moment, so their body and behaviour become a means of communication. Taking a few minutes to prepare can make all the difference between a manageable journey and a distressing one.






## Body Check

Before getting in the car, take a moment to check in on basic comfort needs:

- Have they eaten recently?
- Do they need a drink?
- Do they need to use the bathroom?

Meeting these needs first reduces physical discomfort and frustration, which significantly lowers the chance of escalation during the trip.

## Offer a Meaningful Choice

"Where would you like to sit?" or "Would you prefer music, or would you like it quiet?"

Adults with IDD should have control over their daily routines. Offering genuine, manageable choices respects their autonomy and gives them a sense of agency in the journey. Feeling heard and in control often leads to greater comfort and cooperation.





## Set a Clear, Shared Expectation

"We're heading to [destination]. It should take about 20 minutes. Let me know if you need anything along the way."

Clear, calm information about what to expect reduces anxiety for adults who rely on predictability and routine. The aim is to orient the person to the journey, giving them a sense of how long it will last and what they can expect. Familiarity and transparency are calming in themselves.

# During the Ride: Supporting Regulation

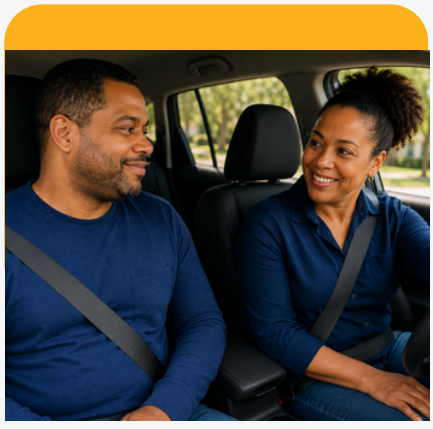
A quiet ride is not always a regulated ride. Adults with IDD may need gentle engagement and reassurance to remain calm and settled, particularly on longer journeys or unfamiliar routes.

## Narrate or Orient if Helpful

"We're coming up to the highway now," or
"About ten more minutes and we'll be there."

Gentle verbal orientation keeps the person grounded in the present moment and reduces the anxiety of not knowing where they are in the journey. This is especially helpful for individuals who experience heightened anxiety or difficulty with transitions. Follow their lead; some people find narration reassuring; others prefer quiet. Both are valid.





## Acknowledge Positive Moments

"You're travelling really well today, thanks for letting me know when you needed a break."

Noticing and naming positive moments builds confidence and reinforces the person's own capacity to manage challenging situations. It shifts the focus from managing behaviour to recognising the person's strengths. Affirmation works best when it's genuine, specific, and respectful — not performative or condescending.

# If Distress Occurs: Staying Calm and Safe

Distress during transport is not intentional disruption, it is a signal that the person's nervous system is overwhelmed and they need support, not correction.



**Silence**
Reduce language. Avoid instructions, explanations, or reasoning in the moment.

A dysregulated nervous system has trouble processing words. Fewer words mean less to process, and more room for the person to settle.



**Safety First**
If the person unbuckles their seatbelt or the situation becomes unsafe, pull over calmly. The vehicle does not move until everyone is safe.

This is a clear, non-punitive boundary that protects everyone. Delivering it calmly and without frustration communicates that safety is the priority, not compliance.



**Soothe**
Use a low, calm voice: "I can see this is hard right now. We're going to stay here for a moment until you feel ready."

Acknowledging the person's experience without judgment helps them feel seen and safe, which supports the nervous system in returning to a regulated state. Avoid asking questions or problem-solving until calm has been restored.

# What We Avoid — and Why

- Threats or the removal of items or activities as punishment
- Repeated commands such as "No," "Stop," or "Calm down"
- Consequence-based or punishment-driven responses

These approaches heighten stress, undermine trust, and can damage the relationship between the person and their support worker or carer. They may interrupt a behaviour momentarily, but they don't build capacity, and they often make future journeys harder. Adults with IDD deserve support strategies rooted in respect, not control.

# Every Journey Starts With Care

Supporting someone with an intellectual or developmental disability during transportation requires patience, understanding, and consistency.

Some days may feel easier than others, and that is completely normal. Building positive transportation experiences takes time, trust, and learning what works best for each individual. The small things matter: preparing ahead, recognizing communication, offering reassurance, and creating a sense of safety. Your support makes every journey more comfortable, meaningful, and empowering.

At La Necar Logistics, we believe transportation should never feel like just a trip. It should be an experience where every individual feels respected, understood, and cared for.

**Because when care comes first, every journey creates confidence and peace of mind.**

# About La Necar Logistics

La Necar Logistics is an accessible transportation provider serving riders across New Jersey, Pennsylvania, New York, and Connecticut.

We provide IDD travel assistance, wheelchair accessible vehicles, non-emergency medical transportation, rides for seniors, group transportation, and assisted travel services.

At La Necar Logistics, we believe that care comes first in accessible transport, which means understanding each rider's unique support needs and delivering adaptive mobility care tailored to the individual.

Every journey we provide is built around care, respect, consistency, and comfort for the riders and families who trust us.



# Need a Transportation Service You Can Trust?

Every individual deserves a transportation experience built around their needs. Let’s support your individual with reliable, compassionate, and accessible rides.

## Connect With Our Team Today

**New Jersey Services**
services@lanecarlogisticsllc.com

**Pennsylvania Services**
paservices@lanecarlogisticsllc.com

**New York Services**
nyservices@lanecarlogisticsllc.com

**Connecticut Services**
ctservices@lanecarlogisticsllc.com

**Phone:** +1 855-202-9967
**Address:** 30 Bridge St, Hackensack NJ 07601, United States

## Important Note

This guide is intended to provide general information and practical support strategies for caregivers and support teams.

The recommendations shared are not a substitute for professional, medical, behavioral, or clinical advice. Every individual has unique needs, and caregivers should work with qualified professionals when additional assessment, support, or guidance is needed.